The Unsent Letter

Silvia, I found this in the cedar chest of the Sanctuary, under the oldest charts. An Oracle of long ago wrote it, centuries before me, to the Mirror Speaker of Tower III, and never sent it. She wrote it the way the glass sees, as the people of the mirror do. Hold the page up to a mirror and read it.

A.

To the Mirror Speaker of the third tower,

Forgive me. I closed my door to you when your crossed the plateau to see me, and I have been sorry every night since.

Now hear what only we two know. Your mirror did not fall. We broke it together, into nine pieces, and we hid each piece in a different room of your theatre. While the nine are apart, no one can turn the Astrolabe alone: not the Order, not you, not I.

And beware the Ashes. They were old before the Order was born. They keep a fire older than our first star, and they want what the Astrolabe opens. They will come to your smiling.

The first piece sleeps behind a thousand faces. Only the one who sees what is not equal will find it.

The Oracle of the Sandstone Sanctuary

In the mirror the words turn round, and so do the people who wrote them. Tower III is the house of the mirror: there, everything may be the other way round.

A.

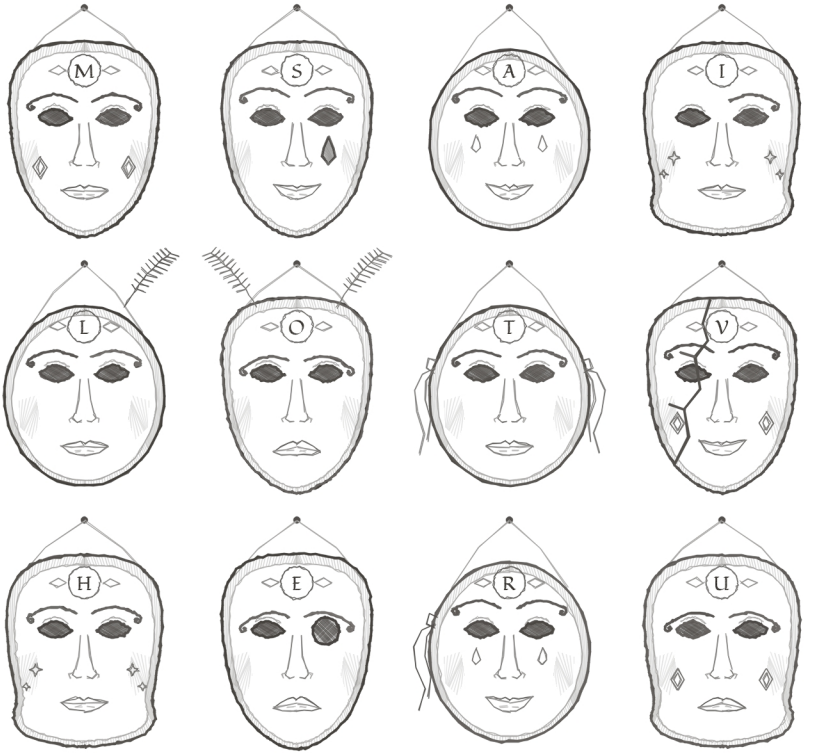
Leonardo wrote his notebooks the same way, from right to left. I always thought he did it to hide his secrets. Perhaps he only wanted to be read by someone patient.

H.

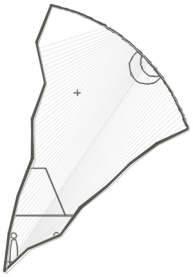
The Gate of a Thousand Masks

The door of Tower III is a wall of masks, and each mask is half a face held up to a mirror. A true face is the same on both sides. Six of these twelve masks lie: their two halves are not equal.

Find the six that lie. Read the letters on their foreheads from left to right, row by row: that is the word the gate is waiting for.



The word of the gate: ☐☐☐☐☐☐



Fragment I

When the gate opens, the first piece of the mirror of Tower III is yours. Keep it: nine pieces make one glass, and the whole glass shows the way.

Its place in the mirror →

